

Task 3: Evaluation and Peer Feedback

Peer Review by Ronaldo Calleja 4.2A DDN

First Impressions & Purpose: The website's purpose as an MCAST redesign is clear from the homepage. It targets prospective students like the persona "Luca" by keeping information professional yet modern.

Strengths:

1. **Aesthetic Appeal:** The site is visually pleasing with a consistent professional colour palette (Primary Blue #000043 and Secondary Blue #1E4560).
2. **Simplicity:** The layout is simple and serves its purpose without clutter. Navigation between the required five pages is intuitive, making it easy to find course info quickly.

Suggestions for Improvement:

1. **Accessibility:** The text is currently difficult for users with reading problems. Increasing the body font size (currently 12px) and improving contrast would help.
2. **Content Clarity:** While the design is "simple," some sections could benefit from more descriptive headings to guide the user through the course specifications.

Self-Evaluation

Evaluation of Website Redesign

The goal of this project was to redesign the MCAST website to cater specifically to prospective students. My research in Task 1 indicated that 66.7% of users prioritise "getting information quickly" over a beautiful design. Consequently, I focused on a "Simple and Easy to Use" approach, which 50% of my survey respondents preferred.

Successes in Design and Functionality

My final website successfully implemented the Style Guide established in my design document. I used a consistent grid layout and a professional colour scheme that my peer described as "aesthetically pleasing." By utilising semantic HTML5 and a central CSS3 stylesheet, I ensured the site was technically sound and easy to navigate. The primary goal of my persona, Luca Farrugia, finding course information quickly, was

met through a streamlined menu structure that addressed the "poor navigation" frustration identified in my initial research.

Addressing Weaknesses and Feedback

However, the peer feedback highlighted a significant area for improvement: Accessibility. While I aimed for a "modern and clean" look, my peer noted that the text is not ideal for people with reading problems. Looking back at my typography choices, a body text size of 12px is likely too small for universal accessibility.

If I were to further develop this project, I would focus on Task 2B: Accessibility and Usability. I would increase the base font size to at least 16px and use ARIA labels to ensure screen readers can navigate the site. Additionally, although 100% of my survey respondents were prospective students, I would like to expand the "Services" section to better serve the "Alumni" or "Current Students" personas to make the site a more comprehensive tool for the entire MCAST community.